MAJOR GENERAL DR MUHAMMAD ASGHAR (RETIRED), HILAL-I-IMTIAZ (MILITARY), PhD

Recipient - Hilal-i-Imtiaz (Military) | Australian Army Gold Standard | UN Military Observer Medal
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CORE COMPETENCIES

- Strategic Leadership
- Governance Reforms
- Higher Ed Transformation
- International Diplomacy
- Policy & Strategy
- Innovation & HRD
- Crisis/Change Management
- Inclusive Education
- Stakeholder Engagement

HONOURS & DECORATIONS

- Hilal-i-Imtiaz (Military), Govt of Pakistan (2nd highest military award)
- Australian Army Gold Standard, conferred by Chief of Army
- United Nations Military Observer Medal

EDUCATION

- **PhD** (Management Sciences), COMSATS University Islamabad
- **MPhil** (National Security), National Defence University
- **Masters of Art & Science of Warfare**; Military General Sciences Balochistan University
- **Master of Military General Sciences,** Peshawar University
- **Master of Management in Defence Studies**, University of Canberra, Australia
- **BSc (Hons)** War Studies; BSc-Pakistan Military Academy
- **National Security & War Course**;
  Australian & Pakistan Command &
  Staff Courses

LANGUAGES & DIGITAL

English, Urdu, Punjabi, Arabic (reading)

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Internationally recognised strategic leader with 35+ years experience across defence diplomacy, higher education transformation, governance reforms, and complex change management. Conceived and established the **National University of Pakistan** and led reform of **400+ Federal Government Educational Institutions** serving over **200,000+** students. Developed high-trust partnerships across governments, academia, and industry to deliver measurable outcomes in challenging environments.

SIGNATURE ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Founding Rector, National University of Pakistan (NUP) (2023)**: conceived and launched a federally chartered university; delivered the vision, charter, governance model, and academic blueprint.
- **Transformed FGEIs (400+ institutions; ~14,000 staff; 200,000+ learners)**: modernized governance, digitized operations, and scaled faculty development.
- **Launched Pakistan's first Institute of Inclusive Education**: established research, rehabilitation, diagnostics, and HRD services for differently-abled children.
- **Initiated the GATEWAY Project**: advanced mainstreaming and skills training for the transgender community through education and vocational pathways.
- **Defence Adviser (Australia)**: advanced defence and security ties with Australia, New Zealand, and Fiji; led strategic dialogues and intelligence liaison.
- Led de-radicalisation and rehabilitation programs in conflict zones, integrating security operations with health, education, and livelihood.

STRATEGIC LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE (2019-to date)

Executive Director, Overseas Employment Services (OES)-Fauji Foundation (Apr 2024-Present) Pakistan

As Executive Director OES, is responsible for management of overseas employment, talent identification, capacity building of Human Resources (HR) for national/ multi-national organizations on demand. His role involves extensive collaboration with diplomatic community, public/ private sector organizations including higher education domain. Provides effective leadership to the team while engaging the market.

- **PROFESSIONAL QUALIFICATIONS**
- National Security & War Course (2011/12)
- Australian Command & Staff Course, Canberra (2003)
- Pakistan Command & Staff Course, Quetta (2001)
- Officers Gunnery Staff Course (1999)
- Mid-Career Course (1994); Junior Staff Course (1994)
- Signal Course (1993); Infantry Leadership Course (1992)
- Officer Weapons Course (1991); Basic Military Training (1985-1989)
- Defence Media Awareness (ACSC, 2003)
- UN Induction Training, Liberia (2007)

- **MEMBERSHIPS & BOARDS**
- Member, National Curriculum Council (2019-2023)
- Member, Inter-Provincial Education Ministers Coordination Committee (2019-2023)
- Board Member, Federal Board of Intermediate & Secondary Education (2019-2023)

- **TEACHING & ACADMIC ROLES**
- Directing Staff / Senior Instructor, Command & Staff College, Quetta (2010–2012)
- Instructor, Pakistan Military Academy (1996–1999)
- Taught warfare, HRD/HRM, counter-terrorism, counter- insurgency, nuclear studies
- Researched HR evaluation systems; advised on policy and systemic improvements

Founding Rector, National University of Pakistan (2019-2023)
As founding Rector, conceptualized the establishment of NUP in 2019 and vigorously articulated efforts both in the private and public sectors. Resultantly NUP, a federally chartered institution, potentially the largest university of Pakistan was established in April 2023.

Director General, Federal Government Educational Institutions (2018-2019)
Reformed and restructured Federal Government Educational Institutions, a public sector department with over 400 institutions, approximately 14000 HR and over 200000 students across Pakistan, in all domains transforming it into the lead education provider.

Director General, Army Special Education (2017-2018)
Restructured, reformed and managed 26 special education institutions across Pakistan with focus at horizontal and vertical progression through innovation and diversification of the special education.

Director Institute of Inclusive Education (IIE) Islamabad
Conceptualized and realized the idea of establishing first of its kind institute (inclusive education) in Pakistan with focus at research, rehabilitation, diagnostic facilities and HER development for differently abled children. IIE will work as the nerve center incorporating federal and provincial special educational institutions and the efforts of NGOs and INGOs.

Patron of GATEWAY
As DG FGEIs undertook the initiative of main streaming transgender community and launched GATEWAY project, first ever endeavor to empower trans-community through learning and Skill Development.

- **Senior Military Leadership (2012-2013 & 2016-2018)**
- Provided strategic leadership to the HR of over 8000, effectively managed and administered fleet of vast infrastructure and sophisticated equipment within the framework of defence requirements.
- Successfully managed, led and administered over 4500 HR within the operational domain of the assigned tasks.
- Brigade Commander and Task Force Commander (Leadership role for 4200 personnel) in War on Terror.
- Provided combat leadership in War Zone in conducting kinetic operations.
- Pursued non-kinetic operations against terrorism, sectarianism and militancy.
- Planned, executed and monitored de-radicalization programs and spearheaded multi-pronged de-radicalization in societal domain of the area of responsibility.

- **INTERNATIONAL PARTICIPATION**

Conferences/exercises on IHL, maritime/cyber security, education leadership/management, civil-military relations, de-radicalisation, HRD, governance, and national security in Saudi Arabia, Australia, Indonesia, New Zealand, Fiji, PNG, China, and Solomon Islands (2008–2020).

- **GLOBAL LECTURES & TALKS (SELECTED)**
- University of Western Australia on **'Role of Women in De-radicalization'**.
- Curtin University on **'Pakistan's Role in War on Terror'**.
- University of Canberra on **'Morphology of Terrorism'**.
- Australian National University on **'Pakistan's Contribution in War on Terror'**.
- University of Queensland on **'De-radicalization in Pakistan'**.
- Victoria University of Wellington on **'Strategic Significance of Pakistan'**.
- Sydney University on **'Border Management between Pakistan and Afghanistan'**.
- New Zealand Command and Staff College on **'Terrorism and De-radicalization, Pakistan's Perspective'**.
- Talks at Asia Forum, New Zealand Pakistan Australia Forum and other think tanks.
- Australian 3rd Brigade Townsville on **'Strategic Challenges for Pakistan Army'.**
- National Defence University, Islamabad
- COMSATS University, Islamabad
- Command and Staff College, Quetta
- Command and Staff College, New Zealand
- Command and Staff College, Australia

- Planned and conducted rehabilitation efforts in the War Zone with special emphasis on health, education and creation of economic opportunities for the distressed inhabitants.
- Supervised communication infrastructure development projects in tribal areas and the settled region.
- Articulated civil-military relations in war zone to generate whole of the government response to the multiple challenges.
- Evolved Brigade Operational, intelligence and security plans, and Standing Operating Procedures / Instructions.
- Planned and conducted training activities, briefings, seminars, workshops, and extensive research / analysis work in many hard-core professional issues.
- Managed operational logistics, supplies, procurement and financial matters.

Defence Adviser, High Commission for Pakistan - Australia (2014-2017)

- Interaction with strategic leadership of Australia, New Zealand and Fiji to promote cooperation in defence and security sector with Pakistan.
- Scanning of strategic land scape of South Pacific region to make relevant recommendations to Pakistan for preservation and promotion of national interests.
- Advising High Commissioner on all defence, security, political issues and managing the relations with various communities in Australia as assigned by the High Commissioner. Played a key role in bringing the defence relations between Australia and Pakistan to a new level of enhanced understanding and cooperation.
- Planning and execution of strategic engagement between Australian and Pakistani strategic leadership in the defence and security sector.
- Performed a pivotal role in conducting Annual Defence and Security Talks, and Security Talks between Australia and Pakistan.
- Acting as a bridge between Pakistani and Australian intelligence community.
- Liaised extensively with a range of Australian Government Departments (particularly Department of Defence), think tanks and aligned agencies including ASPI, the Lowy institute, Australian Institute of International Affairs, United Services Institute Canberra, Australian Defence College and Asia Pacific Civil-Military Centre of Excellence.
- Representing Ministry of Defence in Pakistan at all relevant forums.
- Researching and analysing developments surrounding Australia Defence Force, Defence Industry and advancements in Defence Science and Technology.
- Analysing Defence and Security issues, focussing on Australian relations with the Middle East / South Asia, particularly with the Pakistan.

- **REFERENCES**
- Professional references can be provided when required.
- **PUBLICATIONS & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP**

- Asghar, M., Ullah, I., & Bangash, A. H. (2023). *Green inclusive leadership and green creativity in the manufacturing industry*. International Journal of Innovation Science. https://doi.org/10.1108/IJIS-04-2023-0087
- Asghar, Muhammad. (2020). *Forgotten Gunners of Gallipoli: 7th Mountain Indian Artillery Brigade*. In Westerman & Floyed (Eds.), *Clash of the Gods of War*. Big Sky Publishing, pp. 98-110.
- Asghar, M., & Rao, A. (2024). Quality Dynamics in Tertiary Education of Pakistan: Governance & Financial Resources in Affiliated Colleges. FWU Journal of Social Sciences, 18(4), 65-79.

- Analysis of Australian security environment to understand Australian policies / views on regional Defence and Security Issues.
- Perception development and management by maintain necessary links / liaison with the important stakeholders to include: think tanks, institutes and universities' centres dealing with defence and security issues
- Managing Defence Wing in High Commission for Pakistan.

- **Operational Leadership (2008 - 2010)**
- Managed and administered full spectrum of the organization (Over 600 personnel).
- Human resource development of under commands.
- Developed and executed operational, intelligence and security plans and Standing Operating Procedures.
- Conducted complete range of training activities to undertake assigned operational roles, particularly competency in using weapons, ammunition and equipment.
- Administered routine functions and supervised security, health and safety matters.
- Managed operational logistics, supplies chain, procurement and financial matters.
- Supervised maintenance / storage of vital weapons, ammunition and equipment.

United Nations Military Observer - Liberia (2007-2008)

- Supervised, monitored, verified reported cease-fire agreements, separations and withdrawals of forces, and cessation of outside assistance.
- Advised on rehabilitation efforts in area of responsibility.
- Monitored disarmament/ demobilization of military forces.
- Maintaining liaison with, and between, the belligerent factions, other (civilian) UN Agencies, NGOs and neighbouring countries.
- Assisted humanitarian agencies in supervising and conducting POW exchanges, food distribution points and convoys, medical supplies and establishments.
- Observed, and monitored the conflict zone.
- Intelligence collection for UN agencies to identify threats and challenges for execution of their missions.

- **EVIDENCE OF INTERNATIONAL STANDING**
- Recipient of national honour Hilal-i-Imtiaz (Military) and two international recognitions (Australian Army Gold Standard; UNMO Medal).
- Leadership roles with international scope (Defence Adviser, UN Military Observer; Founding Rector of federally chartered university).
- Peer-reviewed publication in an international journal; book chapter with international publisher.
- Invited talks at leading universities and think tanks across Australia and New Zealand.
- **CONTACT & LINKS**

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